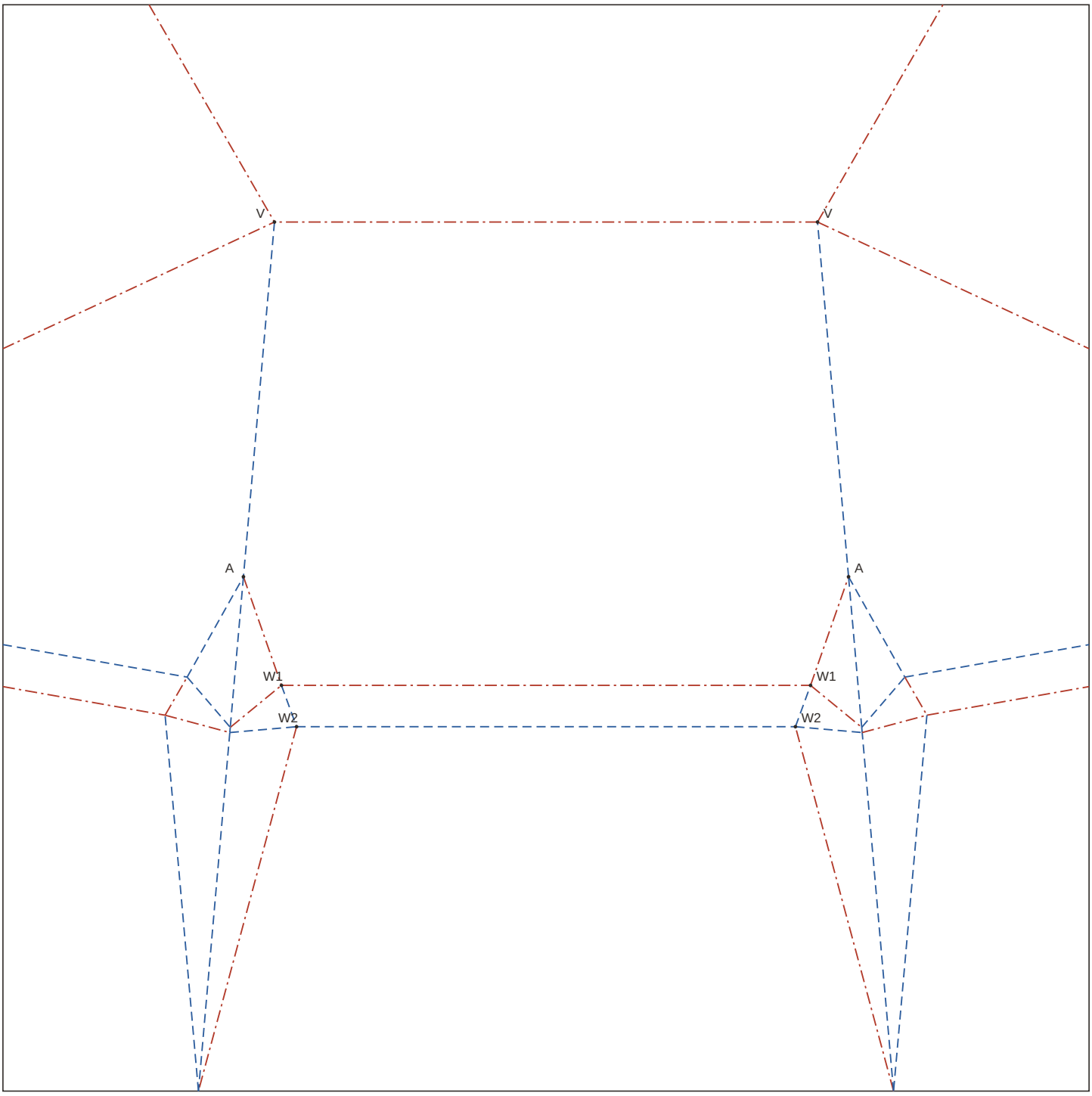
Paper Couture · Coat-dress · crease pattern, actual size

Print at 100% (Actual size, no scaling). Cut along the outer square. Top of the coat at the top.



valley (folds toward you)

mountain (folds away)

50 mm: measure this before folding

Lines are drawn on the side that becomes the collar, the underskirt in the opening and the back yoke (the reverse-colour coat).
Fold with this side up. For a printed coat, start with this side down: the same moves, every crease reversed relative to the paper.
V: shoulder points (four creases meet). A: top of the waist's side creases. W1, W2: the waist pleat's corners.

Coat-dress: folding sequence

A sailor collar in front that becomes a square cape across the back, fronts that meet under the collar and open over an underskirt, short sleeves under the collar, a pleated waist and a flared skirt: one uncut square, two collapses. The app shows each step moving; this sheet is for paper.

1. Precrease every line on the flat sheet, lines side up: valleys toward you, mountains away. Sharp, accurate creases matter most at the shoulder points (V) and at the waist corners near the side seams, where creases are 1 to 3 mm apart.

2. Collapse both shoulders together. Bring the side panels up and in along the side seams (valleys) so the fronts meet at the centre; the strip above the shoulder line folds down behind (mountain). At each V the triangular wedge between the two collar creases turns over the shoulder by itself and lies on top: that is the collar. The short sleeves come down behind it with the back yoke.

3. Check: the fronts meet just under the collar's V and lean apart toward the hem; the collar points sit over the shoulders.

4. Collapse the waist. Below the collar, the two horizontal creases form a pleat across the whole body (mountain above, valley below); at each side the body folds behind along the short side creases, and a small hidden gusset swivels between them. This is the fit-and-flare's waist; it moves as one, so ease it closed rather than forcing one crease.

5. Flatten and press. The skirt flares out to the hem corners; the opening between the fronts shows the underskirt.

Reference points

Millimetres from the bottom-left corner (x to the right, y up), left side. Mirror x for the right side: x' = side - x.

point		190 mm square	8.5 in square (215.9 mm)
V	shoulder point	47.5, 152.0	54.0, 172.7
X1	collar crease meets top edge	25.6, 190.0	29.0, 215.9
X2	collar crease meets side edge	0.0, 129.9	0.0, 147.6
A	top of the waist's side crease	42.1, 90.0	47.8, 102.2
W1	upper waist corner	48.7, 71.0	55.4, 80.6
W2	lower waist corner	51.4, 63.7	58.4, 72.4
corner	side seam meets the hem	34.2, 0.0	38.9, 0.0

Shoulder line at 152.0 mm (190) / 172.7 mm (8.5 in) from the bottom. Side seams lean out 5 degrees. Upper collar crease at 120 degrees from the shoulder line; lower collar crease at 205 degrees.

What paper has to cope with

At a 20 cm square: finished about 14.62 x 15.1 cm; up to 12 layers at the waist corners (thin kami or printer paper is easier than card); the sharpest angle is 10.07 degrees, a sliver at each hem corner; the shortest crease is 0.96 mm, beside the side seam at the waist; the waist pleat is 7.61 mm deep. Nothing locks: both collapses can spring open a little, so a press under a book or a small dab of glue under the collar may help. This pattern passes the app's flat-foldability and rigid-motion checks; it has not yet been folded in paper.

If you fold it

Photograph the front and back beside the app's Display view (same paper side up). Note any step that fought you, anywhere the paper buckled or would not lie flat, and how far the collar points or hem moved from the pattern.